Cassie Huang

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Education

PhD — **Drexel University**, Computer Science — Philadelphia, PA — Sept 2025 – present
- Advisor: Li "Harry" Zhang
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

Master of Science in Engineering — **University of Pennsylvania**, Computer and Information Science — Philadelphia, PA — Sept 2022 – May 2024
- GPA: 3.63/4.00

Bachelor of Arts — **Boston University**, Mathematics and Computer Science — Boston, MA — Sept 2018 – May 2022
- GPA: 3.93/4.00 (summa cum laude)
- Dean's List (Fall 2018
- Fall 2021)
- Thomas M. Menino Scholarship Recipient

Research Experience

Drexel University, PhD Student — Philadelphia, PA — Sept 2024 – present
- Lead two complete research projects involving collaboration across institutions, resulting in NLP publications.
- Leverage LLMs to auto-formalize complex reasoning and planning problems.
- Evaluate LLM-as-formalizer in realistic planning tasks with constrained environments.

University of Pennsylvania, Student Researcher — Philadelphia, PA — Sept 2023 – May 2024
- Extract interpretable lexical and stylistic features for authorship attribution.
- Fine-tune BERT Sentence Transformers for embedding-based analysis.

Boston University, Student Researcher — Boston, MA — June 2019 – Aug 2019
- Studied ambiguity in natural language annotations using tracking datasets.
- Designed MTurk experiments using HTML.

Publications

On the Limit of Language Models as Planning Formalizers — July 2025
Cassie Huang, Li Zhang
aclanthology.org/2025.acl-long.242 (Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers))

Language Model as Planner and Formalizer under Constraints — July 2026
Cassie Huang, Stuti Mohan, Ziyi Yang, Stefanie Tellex, Li Zhang
aclanthology.org/2026.acl-long.624 (Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers))

Unifying Inference-Time Planning Language Generation Jan 2026
Prabhu Prakash Kagitha, Bo Sun, Ishan Desai, Andrew Zhu, Cassie Huang, Manling Li, Ziyang Li, Li Zhang
aclanthology.org/2026.findings-acl.415 (Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026)

Language Models as Higher-Order Planning Formalizers Jan 2026
Owen Jiang, Cassie Huang, Ashish Sabharwal, Li Zhang
arxiv.org/abs/2603.23844 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.23844)

Asymmetric Capacity Allocation in Self-Refinement Pipelines Jan 2026
Zhuoyi Yang, Ian G. Harris, Salar Hashemitaheri, Cassie Huang, Yuangang Li, Hyunwoo Oh, Paul Dourish, Tony Givargis, Mohsen Imani, Li Zhang
arxiv.org/abs/2608.21345 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.21345)

Planning Commitment of LLM under Partial Observability Jan 2026
Cassie Huang, Zhanwei Cao, Yeawon Lee, Nathalia Gomez, Zhuoyi Yang, Ian G. Harris, Tiffany D. Do, Jiayuan Mao, Li Zhang
arxiv.org/abs/2610.21108 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.21108)

Service

- Reviewer, COLM 2025 Workshop AIA
- Reviewer, ACL ARR January 2026
- Reviewer, ACL 2026 Workshop SURGeLLM
- Reviewer, ACL ARR August 2026

Teaching

- Course Assistant, CS237: Probability in Computing, Boston University, Fall 2021, Spring 2022
- Teaching Assistant, CIS5210: Artificial Intelligence , University of Pennsylvania, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025
- Teaching Assistant, CIS5200: Machine Learning, University of Pennsylvania, Spring 2024
- Teaching Assistant, CIS5300: Natural Language Processing, University of Pennsylvania, Summer 2024, Spring 2025
- Teaching Assistant, CS-T780: Applied NLP, Drexel University, Spring 2025
- Guest Lecture, CS614 and CS-T780, Drexel University, Spring 2026

Work Authorization

Status: U.S. Citizen — No sponsorship required